

Replication files

Does the election of a female leader clear the way for more women in politics?

This Zip-file contains the datasets and Stata code to reproduce all regression tables and figures reported in the paper and in the online appendix. To reproduce all regression tables, run the file *generate_all_tables.do* after adjusting the global macro "path" in that file to match the folder structure on your system. To reproduce all figures, run the file *generate_all_figures.do*, again after adjusting the global macro "path". The results can then be found in the folders *results_tables* and *results_figures*.

In the following, we describe in detail the code, datasets, and variables used in the paper.

1 Folder ado files

This folder contains three ado files.

bandwidth_and_weights.ado	This file contains the code for the RDD optimal bandwidth calculations.
rdd_plot.ado	This file contains the code for the RDD graphs.
post_ttest.ado	This file contains the code for the t-tests on municipality characteristics.

2 Folder Datasets

This folder contains eight datasets with which all results in the paper can be reproduced.

main_dataset.dta	This dataset contains the council election candidate data. Most results in the paper can be reproduced with this dataset (i.e. all results that are not mentioned below). The dataset was compiled using the official and hand collected data on local council candidates as described in Section A.1 in the online Appendix and official data on mayor elections.
characteristics_mixed_and_single_gender_municipalities.dta	This dataset contains data on municipality characteristics for both municipalities that had at least a mixed-gender mayor election and municipalities that never had such an election. This dataset is used to explore external validity (Table A.15).
dataset_for_party_level_results.dta	This dataset is used to explore party-level effects of female mayors (Table A.19).
dataset_with_lagged_rank_improvements.dta	This dataset relates the gender of the current mayor to the rank improvement of women in the previous election (Table A.8).
dataset_with_rank_improvements_next_election.dta	This dataset relates the gender of the current mayor to the rank improvements of female candidates in the next election (Table A.9).
mayor_election_data.dta	This dataset includes information on all mayor elections (e. g. gender of the winner, supporting party, year of election). This dataset is used for Tables A.1, A.4, A.6, and A.7.
municipality_characteristics_data.dta	This dataset contains data on the characteristics of municipalities in the period 1992-2015. This dataset is used for Table A.4.
neighbor_regressions_dataset.dta	This dataset contains the data on mayors in an index municipality i and female candidates in all neighboring municipalities (Table 9). Neighboring municipalities were identified using a shapefile available from the German Federal Agency for Cartography and Geodesy.

3 Variables

3.1 main_dataset.dta

gkz	Official numeric municipality code.
jahr	Local council election year.
gkz_jahr	Official numeric municipality code merged with local council election year.
rdd_sample	Dummy = 1 if municipality included in the RDD sample (previous mayor was elected in a mixed-gender election).
female	Dummy = 1 if council candidate is female.
elected	Dummy = 1 if council candidate is elected to the council.
gewinn_norm	Normalized rank improvement.
gewinn	(non-normalized) Rank improvement.
gewinn_dummy	Dummy = 1 if positive rank improvement for council candidate.
listenplatz_norm	Normalized initial list rank of council candidate.
joint_party	Dummy = 1 if council candidate and mayor from same party.
age	Age of council candidate.
non_university_phd	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's highest degree is high-school.
university	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's highest degree is university diploma.
phd	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's highest degree is PhD.
architect	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's employment is architect.
businessmanwoman	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's employment is businessman/-women.
engineer	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's employment is engineer.
lawyer	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's employment is lawyer.
civil_administration	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's employment is employed in civil administration.
teacher	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's employment is teacher.
employed	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's is employee.
selfemployed	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's is self-employed.
student	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's is student.
retired	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's is retired.
housewifehusband	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's is housewife/-husband.
incumbent_council	Dummy = 1 if council candidate's was already elected to the previous council (incumbent).
wahlbet	Turnout in the local election.
party	Party of the council candidate

female_mayor	Dummy = 1 if the elected mayor in a mixed-gender election is female.
margin_1	Margin of victory of the female mayor candidate in a mixed-gender mayor election.
inter_1	Interaction between the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate in a mixed-gender mayor election and the female mayor dummy.
margin_2	Quadratic transformation of the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate.
inter_2	Interaction between the quadratic transformation of the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate and the female mayor dummy.
female_mayor_full_sample	Dummy = 1 if elected mayor is female (irrespective of whether the election was mixed-gender or not).
sum_years_as_mayor	Tenure of the current mayor (in years).
mayor_age	Age of the current mayor.
mayor_university	Dummy=1 if mayor has university degree.
mayor_employment	Dummy =1 if mayor was previously employed in civil administration.
log_bevoelkerung	Log of municipality population.
log_flaeche	Log of municipality area.
log_debt_pc	Log of municipality public debt per capita.
log_tottaxrev_pc	Log of tax revenues per capita.
log_gemeinde_beschaeft_pc	Log of local government employees per capita.
log_female_sh_gem_besch	Log of share of women among local government employees.
log_tot_beschaeft_pc	Log of total employment per capita in a municipality.
log_female_share_totbesch	Log of share of women among all employees.
log_prod_share_tot	Log of share of employees in manufacturing among all employees.
log_female_share_prod	Log of share of women among all employees in manufacturing.

3.2 characteristics_mixed_and_single_gender_municipalities.dta

gkz	Official numeric municipality code.
mixed_gender_muni	Dummy = 1 if municipality had at least one mixed-gender mayor election during the sample period.
single_gender_uni	Dummy = 1 if municipality never had a mixed-gender mayor election.
log_bevoelkerung	Log of municipality population.
log_flaeche	Log of municipality area.
log_debt_pc	Log of municipality public debt per capita.
log_tottaxrev_pc	Log of tax revenues per capita.
log_gemeinde_beschaeft_pc	Log of local government employees per capita.
log_female_sh_gem_besch	Log of share of women among local government employees.
log_tot_beschaeft_pc	Log of total employment per capita in a municipality.
log_female_share_totbesch	Log of share of women among all employees.
log_prod_share_tot	Log of share of employees in manufacturing among all employees.
log_female_share_prod	Log of share of women among all employees in manufacturing.

3.3 dataset_for_party_level_results.dta

gkz	Official numeric municipality code.
jahr	Local council election year.
mean_frau	Share of women on party list.
female_mayor	Dummy = 1 if the elected mayor in a mixed-gender election is female.
margin_1	Margin of victory of the female mayor candidate in a mixed-gender mayor election.
inter_1	Interaction between the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate in a mixed-gender mayor election and the female mayor dummy.
margin_2	Quadratic transformation of the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate.
inter_2	Interaction between the quadratic transformation of the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate and the female mayor dummy.
gkz_jahr	Official numeric municipality code merged with local council election year.
partei	Name of party.
voteshare	Vote share of party.

3.4 dataset_with_lagged_rank_improvements.dta

gkz	Official numeric municipality code.
jahr	Local council election year.
gkz_jahr	Official numeric municipality code merged with local council election year.
gewinn_norm	Normalized rank improvement in the previous election.
female	Dummy=1 if local council candidate is female.
female_mayor	Dummy = 1 if the elected mayor in a mixed-gender election is female.
margin_1	Margin of victory of the female mayor candidate in a mixed-gender mayor election.
inter_1	Interaction between the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate in a mixed-gender mayor election and the female mayor dummy.
margin_2	Quadratic transformation of the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate.
inter_2	Interaction between the quadratic transformation of the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate and the female mayor dummy.

3.5 dataset_with_rank_improvements_next_election.dta

gkz	Official numeric municipality code.
jahr	Local council election year.
gkz_jahr	Official numeric municipality code merged with local council election year.
gewinn_norm	Normalized rank improvement in the next election.
female	Dummy=1 if local council candidate is female.
female_mayor	Dummy = 1 if the elected mayor in a mixed-gender election is female.
margin_1	Margin of victory of the female mayor candidate in a mixed-gender mayor election.
inter_1	Interaction between the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate in a mixed-gender mayor election and the female mayor dummy.
margin_2	Quadratic transformation of the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate.
inter_2	Interaction between the quadratic transformation of the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate and the female mayor dummy.

3.6 mayor_election_data.dta

gkz	Official numeric municipality code.
jahr	mayor election year.
election_year	mayor election year as string.
mayor_election_year	Dummy=1 if mayor election year.
geschl_first_placed	Gender of winner of the mayor election as string.
rdd_sample	Dummy=1 if mixed-gender mayor election.
cdu_winner	Dummy=1 if winner of mayor election supported by CDU.
spd_winner	Dummy=1 if winner of mayor election supported by SPD.
other_party_winner	Dummy=1 if winner of mayor election supported by party other than CDU or SPD .
female_mayor	Dummy = 1 if the elected mayor in a mixed-gender election is female.
male_mayor	Dummy = 1 if the elected mayor in a mixed-gender election is male.
margin_l	Margin of victory of the female mayor candidate in a mixed-gender mayor election.

3.7 municipality_characteristics_data.dta

gkz	Official numeric municipality code.
jahr	Year of observation.
log_bevoelkerung	Log of municipality population.
log_flaeche	Log of municipality area.
log_debt_pc	Log of municipality public debt per capita.
log_tottaxrev_pc	Log of tax revenues per capita.
log_gemeinde_beschaeft_pc	Log of local government employees per capita.
log_female_sh_gem_besch	Log of share of women among local government employees.
log_tot_beschaeft_pc	Log of total employment per capita in a municipality.
log_female_share_totbesch	Log of share of women among all employees.
log_prod_share_tot	Log of share of employees in manufacturing among all employees.
log_female_share_prod	Log of share of women among all employees in manufacturing.

3.8 neighbor_regressions_dataset.dta

gkz	Official numeric municipality code.
jahr	Local council election year.
gkz_jahr	Official numeric municipality code merged with local council election year.
female_mayor	Dummy = 1 if the elected mayor in a mixed-gender election is female.
margin_1	Margin of victory of the female mayor candidate in a mixed-gender mayor election.
inter_1	Interaction between the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate in a mixed-gender mayor election and the female mayor dummy.
margin_2	Quadratic transformation of the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate.
inter_2	Interaction between the quadratic transformation of the margin of victory of the female mayor candidate and the female mayor dummy.
female_neighbor	Dummy if a council candidate in neighboring municipality is female.
gewinn_neighbor_norm	Rank change of female council candidate in neighboring municipality.
